
> Free Software Isn't Gratis

Christopher Tineo

Senior DevOps Engineer @ Game Plan Tech

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➤ whoami █

The five acts

"Free" has a price. Someone always pays it.

Open source is everywhere

› clarification

Free software ≠ Open source

Two overlapping but distinct philosophies. Same code, different why.

"Free" as in beer vs "free" as in speech

What it looks like when the bill comes due.

What is ingress-nginx?

The announcement → EOL

The humans behind the controller

Why it collapsed

To companies. To maintainers. The AI threat.

Cost to companies

Cost to maintainers

Vulnerabilities are becoming significantly more frequent and severe due to AI

Stop calling it free. Start treating it like infrastructure.

Open source is critical infrastructure

What could I do?

› the new reality ■

The build-vs-buy equation has flipped

What you do on Monday morning.

What you do on Monday

› terminal

Tagging & tracking with gh / glab

› enterprise-tool

Automating with OSS Review Toolkit (ORT)

This is fine.

It's only fine if we pay for it.



Thank you · Christopher Tineo · Game Plan Tech

kubernetes.io/blog/2026/01/29/ingress-nginx-statement · gnu.org/philosophy/free-sw

Happy 12th Anniversary, Kubernetes!

